

Fossils

Fossils are the remains of ancient animals and plants preserved in rock. They were buried by sand or mud and turned to stone over millions of years.

Paleontologist

Paleontologists use fossils to find out what plants, animals, and other living things were like in the past.

Paleontologists use special tools to dig up, or excavate, fossils.

Fossils are found when the rock above wears away.

Fossils are dug up carefully, so they aren't damaged.

Sometimes a whole fossil skeleton is found.

Dinosaurs

Dinosaurs were spectacular reptiles that ruled Earth from 245 to 66 million years ago. Dinosaur fossils include bones, teeth, eggs, footprints, and even poop!



Skull of Iguanodon



T. rex's scary teeth were up to 12 in (30 cm) long!

Tyrannosaurus rex skeleton



Fossilized egg of Oviraptor